sided with Pakistan[65] and brought up the Kashmir matter in the UN Security Council and General Assembly.[66] Following Xi and Modi's informal meeting in October 2019, India argued that Kashmir and Pakistan had not been on the agenda but that the leaders agreed on the need to fight terrorism. China, on the other hand, reported that Xi, who had hosted Pakistan's Prime Minister Imran Khan in Beijing two days prior to the Chennai meeting, had encouraged dialogue between India and Pakistan.[67] The Modi government has held its course over Kashmir, however, arguing that the measures have no implications for India's external boundaries.[68] India has also carefully taken every opportunity provided by the Kashmir issue to protest against the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor, which will pass through India-claimed, Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, in Gilgit-Baltistan. In March 2020, India objected to a mention of Jammu and Kashmir in a joint statement by China and Pakistan and protested against "the illegal" CPEC.[69]

Increasing Sino–Indian geopolitical rivalry

In his much-acclaimed 2001 book on Sino–Indian relations, *Protracted Contest*, John W. Garver argues that ever since India and China established modern states in the mid-20th century, they have been locked in a complex rivalry ranging across the South Asian region.[70] A rivalry is a competition, conflict or confrontation between two or more persons, groups, or countries. However, the word "rival" can also mean "equal" or "peer," meaning that someone or something possesses characteristics and qualities of similar or even equal magnitude.[71] Looking at change over time,